Neon Flush — Technical Sheet

Tech

One self-contained HTML file (about 24 KB), no libraries, images or network. DOM cards with CSS transitions for crisp touch targets, HTML5 Canvas 2D background (synthwave grid, starfield, particles, screenshake) at up to 2x pixel ratio. Web Audio API synthesized chiptune music that speeds up each ante, plus effects for every chip and mult step. localStorage for save, best run and mute.

Systems

Hand evaluator: 9 poker hands including ace-low straights; only the cards that form the hand score.

Scoring pipeline: base hand (with Planet levels) → card chips → 14 Wildcards (flat, conditional, scaling and multiplicative), animated step by step.

Blinds: 8 antes × 3 blinds, targets 220 to 24,000.

Economy: blind rewards, unused-hand bonus, interest, shop of 2 Wildcards + 1 Planet, reroll and sell.

Audit 1: Balance (simulated play)

A bot that tries every possible play each turn, uses discards and shops, ran hundreds of runs. First targets: it won 72% (too easy, though 8% died on Ante 1). Steeper later antes: 51%. Final curve (220/500/950/1600/2700/4500/7500/12000 base, x1.5 Big, x2 Boss): the perfect-play bot wins 41% and under 2% die on Ante 1, with most losses on Antes 6 to 8. Humans play less than perfectly, so a full clear is a real achievement.

Audit 2: Bugs

A stubbed-DOM harness played 20 full runs through blinds, shop and loss screens. Fixed: a crash after losing (the HUD updated after the run ended), and saving could throw in private browsing where storage is blocked. Audio failure never blocks play. Script syntax validated.

Audit 3: Player experience

Added a live hand preview with Chips × Mult before you commit, a Hand Values table on the menu, a "Last hand! Need X" warning, glowing scoring cards and popping Wildcards so you see why you scored, a progress bar to the target, the interest rule shown in the shop, and sort by rank or suit.